TIMUR KHAZIROV

Senior Technical / Balance Game Designer

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Open to relocation · Remote-capable

PROFILE

Technical game designer with 5+ years of professional experience on multiplayer and live-service games in Unreal Engine and Unity, and three shipped commercial titles.

I own features from design through release, prototype gameplay in Blueprints and C++, balance combat, progression and economy systems, and work closely with engineering teams.

A strong technical background lets me iterate on gameplay quickly, build prototypes myself and create internal production tools.

Built 50+ mechanics across shipped games and personal projects in C#, C++ and Blueprints.

Mentored junior designers; contributed to commercial PC and mobile titles.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Weapon & combat mechanics • In-engine implementation (Blueprints / C++) • Rapid prototyping & iteration • Systems integration • Vehicle & locomotion prototyping • Design & technical documentation • Cross-department collaboration • Tools & workflow improvement • Mentoring & feedback • Balance & economy • Systemic design

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Design	Weapon & combat mechanics, gameplay systems integration, rapid prototyping & iteration, vehicle/locomotion prototyping, player progression, economy design, design & technical documentation
Unreal Engine	UE4/UE5, Blueprints, C++ gameplay programming, Gameplay Tags, Enhanced Input, Animation Blueprints, Behavior Trees, AI Controllers, State Machines, Data Tables, Primary Data Assets, NavMesh, Gameplay Debugging
Unity	C#, MonoBehaviour, ScriptableObjects, NavMesh, gameplay implementation & prototyping
Programming	C++, C#, Python
Tools	Git, Bitbucket, Jira, Confluence, Miro, Rider, Visual Studio, Excel / Google Sheets

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Game Designer (Balance / Technical) — GFAGAMES

Nov 2024 — Present

Project: PIONER (Steam, released) — multiplayer open-world survival shooter, Unreal Engine 5

- Owned four features end-to-end, from spec to in-engine implementation in Blueprints: hip-fire spread, dynamic crosshair, automatic reload and a full rework of the perk system — all integrated into existing systems without breaking them.
- Balance a set of interconnected systems: combat, economy, progression, loot, crafting, vendor pricing and boss parameters.
- Built a C++ tool that walks a level and exports every loot spawner (~3,000 on the largest map) with its loot tables and expected item counts to CSV, so loot can be balanced across the whole map in spreadsheets.
- Prototype and iterate on weapons, armor, consumables and enemies for live updates, based on internal testing and player feedback.
- Work hands-on inside existing Behavior Trees and C++ systems to understand how mechanics interact before changing them; fix gameplay issues via Blueprints.
- Write and maintain balance tables and feature specs; mentor junior designers and review their design documents.
- Work closely with engineers and artists to take new weapons and systems from concept to live content.

Technical Game Designer — 101XP

Mar 2023 — Nov 2024

Project: The Braves (Steam, released) — live-service action game in the spirit of Vampire Survivors, Unity

- Built an internal tool that moves content data from Google Sheets into the project's admin panel — content integration became 10× faster.
- Wrote 20+ specs for artists and programmers and supported many mechanics — hero skills, weapon mechanics, boss variations — from concept through implementation and balance.
- Owned gamepad support and player-facing UI/UX flows, including a redesign of the achievement interface.
- Set up content for live updates, calculated part of an in-game event's balance, tuned enemy difficulty, rewards and the gacha economy.
- Worked daily with programmers, artists and UI artists to ship ongoing live-service content.

Technical Game Designer — 101XP

Dec 2022 — Mar 2023

Project: Craft of Survival (Google Play, released) — single-player survival RPG, Unity

- First project after moving from QA into design: set up new content for regular updates.
- When support for the project was paused and most of the team left, I was one of two designers who shipped a major unfinished update: fixed collisions, NavMesh and enemy spawners in Unity myself, learning the studio's internal tools on the fly.

QA Specialist (part-time while studying) — 101XP

May 2021 — Dec 2022

- Part-time role while finishing university and my entry point into the industry: learned production pipelines, bug triage and debugging workflows from the inside.

PERSONAL PROJECTS

UE5 Helicopter Prototype — Flight model based on real lift, torque and drag formulas, plus a gimbal-mounted turret; Blueprints and C++. (Completed)

Bot Arena (Unity) — Wave shooter inspired by COD: Zombies — enemy AI, wave spawning, three arenas, in-game shop, grenade rocket jump. github.com/KhazirovTimur/BotArena (Completed)

Tiny Dozzer (Mobile) — Arcade game about a bulldozer clearing trash, built in Unity; previously released on Google Play.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- Bauman Moscow State Technical University — Specialist degree (5-year, equivalent to Bachelor's + Master's), Information Security, 2022
- Michigan State University — Introduction to Game Development (Coursera certificate)
- Michigan State University — Principles of Game Design (Coursera certificate)

ADDITIONAL SKILLS

Blender (basic) • Adobe Photoshop, Premiere • Basic SFX and music creation • Ableton Live, Reaper

LANGUAGES

Russian — Native | English — C1